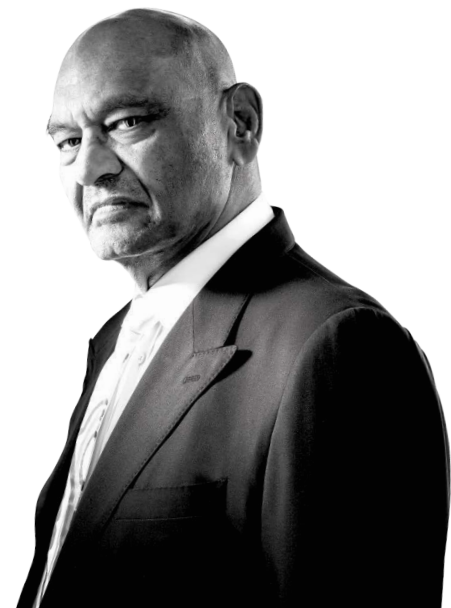
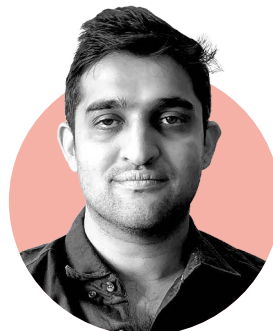


DEBT AND DEMERGER

EVEN PEOPLE WHO knew *Anil Agrawal* well were surprised by his decision to separate Vedanta Ltd into six entities. While it was driven by high debt and pressure to make big repayments over two years, analysts worry it might cause earnings volatility and worry lenders. However, investors can benefit from investing in multiple firms rather than a holding company. Vedanta has been struggling, and the demerger may help to turn things around.



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CLIFFHANGER

THE YEAR 2024 is going to be crucial for Byju's. A lot depends on the success of what Founder *Byju Raveendran* (top) and CEO *Arjun Mohan* have set out to achieve. While Raveendran is focussing on vital corporate tasks, Mohan is spearheading an organisational and business restructuring. Consequently, the company's survival depends on the outcomes of the combined efforts of these two individuals. Will they be able to turn around the beleaguered edtech firm?

RIDING ON AI

AI remained a major focus in 2023, and the momentum is expected to continue in 2024. AI start-ups, especially generative AI start-ups like OpenAI, Stability AI, and Anthropic, received over \$68.7 billion in funding in 2023, per Pitch-Book. Those solving real-world challenges in sectors such as healthcare and finance have attracted VCs. In 2024, generative AI and large language models are expected to become more refined. Therefore, more AI funds are expected to emerge and seize this opportunity.

ELECTRIC DREAMS

Ola Founder & CEO *Bhavish Aggarwal*, 38, had a stellar 2023, leading his EV scooter venture to a 30-35 per cent market share. In 2024, he plans to list Ola Electric on the stock market through an IPO that targets raising \$662 million at a valuation of \$7-8 billion. In addition to its Krutrim AI venture, the company has lofty electric car plans. Currently under construction in Tamil Nadu, the 115-acre mega lithium-ion cell factory is expected to start production in February. Much hinges on 2024 for Aggarwal, as he must justify Ola's valuation and complete these goals.

